

However, the developers are not the only ones in charge of procuring a cryptoasset; they only provide the code. The people who own and maintain the computers that run the code—the miners—also have a say in the development of the code because they have to download new software updates. The developers can't force miners to update software. Instead, they must convince them that it makes sense for the health of the overall blockchain, and the economic health of the miner, to do so.⁷

In addition to the developers and miners, there is a third level of governance among the procurers: the companies that offer services that interface between the cryptoasset and the broader public. These companies often employ some of the core developers, but even if they don't, they can assert significant influence over the system if they are a large force behind user adoption.

After the three groups of procurers, there are the holders or the end users who buy the cryptoasset for investment purposes or to gain access to the utility of the underlying blockchain architecture. These users are constantly providing feedback to the developers, miners, and companies, in whose interest it is to listen, because if users stop using the cryptoasset, then demand will go down and so too will the price. Therefore, the procurers are constantly held accountable by the users.

Last, there is an emerging regulatory landscape for cryptoassets. However, regulators are still considering exactly how they want to handle this emerging asset class.